

Internship Report

Name: Himanshi Sharma

Organization: CRY - Child Rights and You

Internship Duration: 4 weeks

Role: Research and Analysis on CSR Trends in India

Mentors: Ms. Harsha & Ms. Subha

1. Introduction

My internship with CRY – Child Rights and You was deeply enriching and provided me with a newfound perspective and purpose. I was supervised by Ms. Harsha, who guided me directly and provided me with valuable insights. CRY provided me with an opportunity to integrate practice with theoretical knowledge, particularly at the intersection of corporate social responsibility and social development. I remember at the start of the internship, I was tasked with some extensive research and writing an analysis which I later presented. I also participated in small-scale fundraising. Every single task I had been assigned to and to which I actively participated, challenged me to be critical in thought, effective in communication, and empathetic in approach.

2. About CRY - Child Rights and You

CRY is one of the foremost organizations in India dedicated to child welfare. The organization focuses on ensuring that every child has the right to a happy, healthy, and creative development. Its main areas of concern are education, health and nutrition, protection from abuse and exploitation, child labor, and child marriage. One of the most prominent features of CRY is its comprehensive holistic approach to solving problems. Rather than only providing relief to children, CRY plans and implements long-term solutions by involving the community, schools, government, and civil society. The organization's focus on dignity, equity, and inclusion made it a meaningful space for my professional growth.

3. My Role and Responsibilities

My role as a Research and Analysis Intern was to examine the CSR (Corporate Social Responsibility) social trends in India as it pertains to children's development. I prepared an illustrative report analyzing the CSR expenditure trends, their sectoral and geographic emphasis as well as concentration and disparities after the Companies Act 2013 was implemented. Besides that, I authored and co-authored workbooks, developed IT tools aimed at education for the preschool and early childhood development children, and participated in the organization of some activities for children. I also tried to understand the basics of nonprofit fundraising and designed a small campaign.

4. Key Projects

CSR Trends in India: Research & Report Writing

One of my core deliverables was a detailed analytical paper titled "CSR Trends in India". This report scrutinized the national data concerning the expenditures on CSR activities for the years FY 2014 to 2022 and analyzed some key takeaways. It was notable for me that education and healthcare took the foremost share, while environmental sustainability and livelihood promotion suffered from a lack of investment. Also, the uneven between region allocation was notable. States that because of industrialization received a lot of CSR investment, such as Maharashtra, Karnataka and Gujarat were over serviced. The northeast and tribal regions were vastly under serviced. The report also analyzed the shift of CSR positioning from public sector units (PSUs) to private firms and the debate on whether CSR in business is a matter of mere compliance or of real impact. This exercise not only enhanced my research and writing skills but also helped me appreciate the degree to which corporate financing can strategically help or hinder development milestones.

Designing Employee Engagement Activities

Making the Employee Engagement Activity Deck, which has twenty fun and innovative games for kids, was one of the most important things I did during my internship. The activities were Story Cubes, Nutrition Snap Card Games, Zines for Safety Rules, and Clocks for Telling Time. The goal was to strap together kits that could be assembled during volunteering sessions and distributed to children through CRY's outreach programs. Each activity was accompanied by definable goals, learning outcomes, a materials list, and procedural steps for implementation. This was a chance for me to experience the blend of creativity and purposeful education, and it showed me how thoughtfully crafted volunteer engagement could be designed for children.

Assignments on Child Rights Issues

I was given the chance to consider some of the most difficult issues impacting children across India. In my research, I looked into instances of tea, lock, and carpet child labor and thought about which of the many rights I personally resonated the most with — for example the right to hear and the right to protection from sexual abuse. In addition, I researched CRY's programs designed to address child marriage, malnutrition, and the limited access to education in order to understand the impact of such programs through relevant data and case studies. These tasks in the most part, were emotionally challenging, but they equipped me on how to express with clarity, compassion, and resolve.

Fundraising Experience

I didn't have to do any fundraising as part of my internship, but I thought I'd give it a go. I created a tiny personal campaign and was able to raise ₹250. I gained a lot from that experience, even if it wasn't a lot of money. I learnt a lot more about how hard it is to get people emotionally involved, how important support is, and what support is. It helped me understand the story and how to build relationships and trust, which are important for fundraising, yet it made me feel less at ease.

5. Skills Gained

During my internship with CRY, I refined my abilities in various areas, which allowed me to grow both personally and professionally. I researched CSR policies and their spending patterns to achieve social developmental objectives, which in turn strengthened my research and analysis skills. I began improving at synthesizing complex information and drawing meaningful conclusions. While my verbal and written communication skills improved, I crafted reports, guides, and even worksheets which needed to be not only engaging but also instructional. Moreover, I designed engaging educational activities for children which improved my creativity and content design skills. My informal fundraising activities taught me how to engage with the public on sensitive issues initiatively, showcasing to me the emotional intelligence and perseverance needed to deal with the public on sensitive matters. Working with my mentors and the rest of the team gave me greater understanding of the necessity of collaboration and social skills. Most importantly, the internship allowed me to cultivate a greater sense of empathy, purpose, and social responsibility, which I consider as important as any technical skills.

6. Challenges and How I Navigated Them

An example of an issue that was unique to me was learning how to balance being affected by an issue with being objective, especially in communications. Topics, such as child labor, sexual abuse, or inequality in society, would invoke a feeling of anger or sadness in me. For the most part, I first found it hard to write or create anything as I was overwhelmed with emotions. At the same time, I was aware that advocacy for an issue would need a level of clarity, composure, and credibility for it to be impactful. I eventually learned how to create purposeful stories using that emotional response. This was quite challenging for me, and it contributed to my development as a thoughtful and responsible communicator.

7. Conclusion

My internship at CRY has been one of the most impactful learning experiences I have encountered thus far. While being mentored by Ms. Harsha and Ms. Subha, I was motivated to take initiative and strive my utmost in every task. I was given the freedom to explore, and in doing so was afforded a level of kindness that was, quite frankly, unexpected. I not only advanced my professional competencies in research, writing, and communication, but I also became more socially aware and emotionally aware. This experience in particular further deepened my conviction towards the value of purposeful work, and I aspire to embody the values I have been inculcated with everywhere I go.

8. Acknowledgments

I want to thank Ms. Harsha very much for being my mentor during my internship. She constantly gave me the proper guidance, help, and inspiration, which helped me finish my work. I liked that she let me learn and grow by exploring on my own. I appreciated her letting me learn and grow through my own exploration. I would also like to acknowledge CRY – Child Rights and You for providing me with such a wonderful chance to work with a reputable organization. I have thoroughly enjoyed and gained a lot from working with such an organization. I feel very lucky to have worked on such important projects at CRY and will always remember the amazing impact this experience has had on me.